

STUART NEUMANN

Neumann's Flat Round Moves Him Up

Third-best Trophy round of his TEG career, delivered while three rivals imploded around him.

Round three at El Prat's Rosa course produced the best golf of the day. It came from Stuart Neumann, quietly, and without any visible pleasure. Around him the field carded wayward numbers. Neumann settled into a flat, unspectacular rhythm. At one point he ran two holes without dropping a gross shot: a par at the fifth, then a par at the tricky, short sixth. Nothing about the round asked for attention. That was rather the point.

The effect on the standings was significant. Neumann had gone into the round anchored

to the bottom of the Wooden Spoon table, a single shot off safety. His 94 rearranged the picture entirely. Henry Meller took over last place, and the gap back up to Neumann now stood at eight shots. It did nothing to trouble the Trophy leaderboard, where Gregg Williams remained out front. But it was exactly the sort of error-free, forgettable round that rescues a TEG from the wrong end of the table. Neumann spent the afternoon filling in the form correctly while the building burned down around him.

AT A GLANCE

ROUND OF THE DAY
Stuart NEUMANN (+0)

TROPHY LEAD
Gregg WILLIAMS, 8 ahead

GREEN JACKET LEAD
Jon BAKER, 1 ahead

ROUND NET VP
SN 0 | JB +2 | GW +3 | DM +11 | HM +15
ROUND GROSS
SN +22 | JB +23 | DM +29 | GW +35 | HM +37

AFTER R3 • TROPHY
GW -9 | JB -1 | SN +3 | DM +9 | HM +17
AFTER R3 • GREEN JACKET
JB +62 | DM +63 | SN +69 | HM +83 | GW +87

DAVID MULLIN | JON BAKER

Baker Snatches The Jacket Lead

David Mullin's worst gross round of the tournament costs him a lead he had held since the third hole of round one.

David Mullin had held the TEG 6 Green Jacket since the third hole of round one. Fifty-one holes of unbroken leadership, through Costa Brava and PGA Catalunya. At El Prat's Rosa course it finally gave way. He carded his worst gross round to date, a 29. A second round that had him at -1 became a close on 11 over. The damage came in bursts. A

quintuple bogey nine at the 15th, the worst hole of his TEG. Then a quadruple bogey nine at the 18th, offered up as a closing statement.

While Mullin unravelled, Jon Baker gained three shots to par across the last three holes. A par at the 18th was enough to put him into the outright Green Jacket lead by a single stroke. He had taken

a 9 at the 8th earlier in the day, so nobody should mistake this for clean golf. Elsewhere, Gregg Williams retained his grip on the TEG 6 Trophy. The Wooden Spoon changed hands too, Meller dropping to last place and releasing Neumann. Neumann's paperwork, it turned out, was in order.

HENRY MELLER

Two Tens Sink Meller At El Prat

A sextuple bogey at the 8th and a quintuple at the 1st turned a promising week sour in a single round.

Henry Meller's round at El Prat - Rosa came apart in one ugly stretch. He had gone strong in Round 2 at -5. He then swung 20 shots the wrong way to finish this round on 15 over. The damage was concentrated between the 7th and the 10th. Four holes, 14 gross shots, not a single net par: a triple bogey, a sextuple bogey, a double bogey and another triple, in that order. The sextuple arrived at the 8th, one of the hardest holes on the course, and took the form of a 10. It was not his first 10 of the day. He had opened with one at the 1st, a quintuple bogey on the par-5 and the worst hole of his tournament relative to par. At the 17th, the hardest hole on the course, he added a nine. Throughout, he gave the impression of a man conducting normal business.

The cumulative effect carried him to the bottom of the Wooden Spoon race, a position he had not occupied before this round. He now sits eight shots adrift of the next-worst player, which in this competition counts as commanding.

EL PRAT - ROSA

El Prat's Front Nine Bares Its Teeth

A Greg Norman design new to TEG wasted no time turning the run from the 7th to the 10th into a minefield.

Real Club de Golf El Prat's Rosa course made its TEG debut in round 3. Greg Norman designed it, and it left its mark on the same stretch of holes for almost the whole field. The 7th, 8th and 9th were the wrecking ground. The 8th is ranked the hardest hole on the course, and it behaved accordingly.

Jon Baker took a quintuple bogey 9 at the 8th. Gregg Williams made a quadruple bogey at the 7th, then followed with further bogeys at the 8th and 9th. Eight shots gone across three holes. Meller suffered worst of all. A triple bogey at the 7th, then a sextuple bogey 10 at the 8th, then more dropped shots at the 9th and 10th. Fourteen shots lost across four holes.

The damage reshaped the standings. Williams kept his 2013 Trophy lead, trimmed to 8. Baker's meltdown did not stop him snatching the Green Jacket lead from David Mullin, a five-shot gap cut to one. Meller's collapse was the costliest, and it delivered him the Wooden Spoon lead, eight shots ahead of Stuart Neumann.

RECORDS & PERSONAL BESTS

Notable achievements: TEG 6, Round 3

PERSONAL WORSTS

- David Mullin's worst Gross round to date: +29
- David Mullin — +18 Gross on the Back nine is a personal-worst Back nine Gross
- David Mullin — +9 net-vs-par on the Back nine is a personal-worst Back nine net-vs-par

RARE FEATS

- David Mullin runs up a 9 (+5) at the 15th — his career-worst on a par-4
- Henry Meller runs up a 10 (+5) at the 1st — his career-worst on a par-5